THE BULLOCK PRESIDENCY

Series Bible — Document 03: Character Bible, Volume 1

LOCKED: The Age Question & the 28th Amendment

Canon (Option B, as revised by the author): every birthday stays exactly as written. Marc-Anthony is **31** when he announces on April 20, 2023, and **33** on Inauguration Day. His position: **age shouldn't matter. Competence, intelligence, and capability should.** The minimum age requirement made sense for its time, but this is the 21st century, and he's not in his 20s. He turns the outdated rule into a national cause, which makes it the signature "Marc Move": bending an outdated rule by changing it.

Marc's Argument

- *"The Founders wrote 35 in 1787, when life expectancy at birth was under 40 and a 30-year-old had never left his county. I have run a company bigger than most countries, and I've been working since I was 10. Judge me on what I can do, not my birthday."*
- Parity: you can serve in the House at 25 and the Senate at 30, vote and go to war at 18, but you can't be President until 35.
- History: the Constitution has been updated for its time before. The 26th Amendment lowered the voting age to 18 in 1971, and the states ratified it in about 100 days.

The Opposition (Not Nerfed)

- **Originalists and constitutional conservatives:** "You don't rewrite the Constitution for one celebrity."
- **Rival campaigns** (Biden's re-election team, Trump, DeSantis, Haley, Ramaswamy, RFK Jr.) each attack it from their own angle. Ramaswamy (37) and Haley face awkward questions of their own about age and generational change.
- **Secretaries of state** in several states refuse to put an underage candidate on the ballot. (Real precedent: in 2012, 27-year-old candidate Peta Lindsay was kept off ballots in several states.) There are court fights in multiple states.
- **Cornelius Smilley's dilemma:** the amendment would also clear the way for Esther (30) to run sooner, which is his dream, but it hands the White House to Marc. Does he fight it or quietly support it?

Locked Timeline

Date	Event
Thu Apr 20, 2023	Marc announces. Within minutes, the headline everywhere is **"HE'S 31."** #TooYoung and #AgeIsJustANumber trend side by side.
Spring 2023 – 2024	Ballot-access lawsuits. Marc launches the national campaign to change the rule.
Summer 2024	**All in: Marc picks Amond Baker (32) as his running mate.** There is no insurance. If the amendment fails, *neither* of them qualifies, and under the 20th Amendment and the Presidential Succession Act the **Speaker of the House** would act as President. Pundits call it reckless. Marc calls it faith: "If I believe age shouldn't matter, I don't get to hedge." The Bullock–Baker ticket is set.
Mon Jul 1, 2024	Congress passes the **28th Amendment** by the required two-thirds of both chambers, on the 53rd anniversary of the 26th Amendment's ratification. It's a bipartisan coalition, and the single biggest proof of Marc's bipartisanship.
Jul – Dec 2024	The ratification race. Governors call special legislative sessions, and every state vote is a story.
Tue Nov 5, 2024	Election Day. Marc wins the presidency while ratification is still incomplete. Is the President-elect eligible? The country holds its breath.

Date	Event
Tue Dec 17, 2024	The 38th state ratifies on the **same day the Electoral College meets**. The Archivist certifies the amendment soon after (169 days from passage).
Mon Jan 6, 2025	Congress counts the electoral votes.
Mon Jan 20, 2025	Marc-Anthony Bullock is sworn in as the **47th President** at age **33**, the **youngest President in American history** (Theodore Roosevelt was 42; JFK, 43, was the youngest elected). He serves the full first term, Jan 20, 2025 to Jan 20, 2029. **Amond Baker**, 32, becomes the **youngest Vice President in history** (the previous record was John C. Breckinridge at 36).

The 28th Amendment: Proposed Text (author may revise)

Section 1. No person shall be eligible to the Office of President or Vice President who shall not have attained to the Age of twenty-five Years; the requirement of thirty-five Years in Article II, Section 1, Clause 5 is hereby repealed.

Section 2. This article shall take effect upon its ratification.

Marc campaigned to remove the age requirement entirely. The final text is the bipartisan compromise: a floor of **25, matching the House**. (The author can make it a full repeal instead.)

- **Continuity payoff:** the 28th Amendment becomes the precedent for the 2032 wartime amendment suspending the 22nd. That one would be the **29th Amendment**. Supporters say "We did it before." Opponents say "This is how it starts: he's rewritten the Constitution twice."
- **The stakes of the Bullock–Baker bet:** between Election Day and Dec 17, 2024, the whole country knows that if ratification stalls, the Speaker of the House becomes Acting President on Jan 20, 2025. Cornelius Smilley and the opposition work every holdout state.

1. Marc-Anthony Bullock: Locked Core Traits

- **Number-one dream:** a big, gigantic family. Kids are non-negotiable. He believes in **generational wealth**. He loves kids, and kids love him.
- **He bends the rules for good.** When a rule or law is unjust, unfair, or just ridiculous, he takes creative liberties to help people. Fans call it "the Marc Move." Opponents call it "lawless." (A built-in political flashpoint, so no one is nerfed.)
- **Character:** the sweetest, kindest, most loving, compassionate, innocent, and pure man in the world. Also the most successful, powerful, influential, respected, beloved, charitable (he spares no expense), and wealthiest person in the world.
- **A Democrat with Republican values**, and a 100% believer in bipartisanship.
- **Comedy:** genuinely hilarious, and his humor is unhinged, unfiltered, and offensive. The tension: a pure heart with a filthy mouth. His old clips are an opposition-research goldmine.
- **Reported IQ of 250.** Exceptionally outgoing and charismatic, a natural on camera, known for his natural appearance, distinctive features, and effortless charisma.
- **Net worth: over $990 billion and rising every day** (see his profile for where it comes from).

LOCKED: Actor-Singers

Every actor in this story who "also sings" is an actor who happens to know how to sing. They are not recording artists. They sing **only on Broadway or in movie musicals**. This applies to Marc-Anthony, Esther, Amond, Grace, Natasha, Victor, and Joan (and any future actor-singer). Their music awards come from that work: Tonys, and Grammys for Broadway cast albums and movie-musical soundtracks. No solo albums, no pop tours, no radio singles. **The one exception is Tyrese Avery**, who is defined as a global pop star who also acts. Harmony is a dancer-actress, and Tyler is a guitarist-actor.

2. Age Reference & "Black Don't Crack"

Actual ages are exact to each birthday. The **"Looks like"** column tells casting, costume, and on-page description how old each character appears. The press and the internet comment on it constantly ("Victor Donohue is 76?? HOW").

Character	Born	Jan 1, 2023	Apr 20, 2023	Looks like
Marc-Anthony Bullock	Jan 5, 1992	30	31	early-to-mid 20s
Esther Bullock (née Smilley)	Sep 20, 1992	30	30	early 20s
Amond Baker	Feb 10, 1992	30	31	mid 20s
Harmony Baker (née Divine)	Jun 19, 1992	30	30	early 20s
Tyrese Avery	Jul 24, 1991	31	31	mid 20s
Arianna Cummings	Oct 25, 1992	30	30	mid 20s
Tyler Chapman	Jan 4, 1992	30	31	mid 20s
Tayia Boyd	Feb 3, 1992	30	31	early 20s (still carded)
Elxa Bullock	Aug 29, 1990	32	32	mid 20s
Grace Bullock	Apr 12, 1994	28	29	early 20s
Emma Bullock	May 10, 2012	10	10	10
Victoria Bullock	May 10, 2012	10	10	10
Lyric Baker	Apr 20, 2014	8	9	8, turns 9 on Apr 20, 2023
Natasha Bullock (née Donohue)	Jun 2, 1971	51	51	mid 30s
Robert Bullock	Feb 10, 1969	53	54	around 40
Victor Donohue	May 30, 1946	76	76	mid 50s
Joan Donohue (née Mercer)	Apr 17, 1948	74	75	early 50s
Odessa Smilley	Oct 3, 1928	94	94	early 70s
Cornelius Smilley	Aug 8, 1958	64	64	mid 40s
Lorraine Smilley (née Beaumont)	Dec 12, 1961	61	61	early 40s
Dr. Beatrice "Bea" Smilley-Owens	May 5, 1955	67	67	early 50s
Cornelius "Neil" Smilley Jr.	Mar 22, 1984	38	39	early 30s
Simone Smilley	Jul 7, 1987	35	35	late 20s

3. Political Affiliations

Realism notes: California, where most of the cast is registered, uses party registration and the label "No Party Preference" (NPP). **Georgia has no party registration**, so the Smilleys' affiliation shows in which primaries they vote in and which party they hold office under. Hollywood leans heavily Democratic, but not uniformly.

Character	Party	Political profile
Marc-Anthony Bullock	Democrat (CA)	Pro-business, pro-family, strong on defense, faith-friendly, fiscally careful, socially compassionate. He crosses the aisle on instinct.
Esther Bullock	Democrat (CA)	Raised inside the Democratic establishment. More progressive than Marc on some issues, more traditional on others.
Amond Baker	Democrat (CA)	Mainstream Democrat. Labor and arts funding are his issues.
Harmony Baker	Democrat (NY to CA)	Arts education and Juneteenth advocacy (she was born on June 19).
Tyrese Avery	No Party Preference (CA)	Publicly apolitical to protect a global fanbase. Privately votes Democratic.

Character	Party	Political profile
Arianna Cummings	Democrat (CA)	Criminal-justice reform with a law-and-order streak. Holds a JD.
Tyler Chapman	**Republican** (TX to CA)	A Black conservative: libertarian, pro-Second Amendment, small-business focused. A rarity in Hollywood and Marc's bridge to the GOP.
Tayia Boyd	No Party Preference (CA)	Swing voter who votes issue by issue.
Elxa Bullock	Democrat (CA)	Pragmatic, institutional, a vote-counter. Born to be Chief of Staff.
Grace Bullock	Democrat (CA)	Fierce progressive on social media, ferociously loyal to Marc offline.
Natasha Bullock	Democrat (CA)	Mega-donor. Gives to whoever protects Donohue Entertainment's interests.
Robert Bullock	Independent / NPP (CA)	Distrusts both parties. His films have skewered each.
Victor Donohue	Democrat (CA)	Old-school Black business Democrat. Has donated to Republicans when it served the company.
Joan Donohue	Democrat (CA)	Civil-rights-era Democrat. Grew up in Atlanta (see the feud).
Odessa Smilley	Democrat (GA)	Living memory of the movement. A kingmaker in Black church politics.
Cornelius Smilley	Democrat (GA, DC)	Establishment Democratic kingmaker. Would ally with anyone, Republicans included, to destroy Marc.
Lorraine Smilley	Democrat (GA, DC)	Washington power hostess and the family's real strategist.
Dr. Bea Smilley-Owens	Democrat (GA)	Civil-rights attorney. The family's conscience.
Neil Smilley Jr.	Democrat (GA)	Georgia State Senator (metro Atlanta).
Simone Smilley	**Republican** (DC)	GOP strategist and cable news contributor. The family's black sheep.
Emma, Victoria, Lyric	n/a (minors)	Too young to vote. Emma turns 18 on May 10, 2030, and can vote in the 2030 midterms and in 2032.

4. The Bullock–Donohue Family

VICTOR DONOHUE, Patriarch

Born: May 30, 1946 **Age:** 76 on Jan 1, 2023 / 76 on Apr 20, 2023

Party: Democrat **Fame:** Living legend (A-list since the 1970s)

- Born in Los Angeles. Grandson of founder Elijah Donohue and the third generation to run **Donohue Entertainment** (founded 1923; see Bible 04). A movie star in his own right in the early 1970s before taking over as CEO at 30. CEO from 1976 to 2006, Chairman since 2006. A billionaire.
- Respected, powerful, influential, ruthless, dangerous, and insanely wealthy. An award-winning actor, singer, producer, and director.
- Married **Joan Mercer** in 1970. While filming in Atlanta in 1969, he met Joan, who was then engaged to Thaddeus Smilley. That is the first wound of the feud.
- Adores his grandchildren. Sees Marc as the culmination of everything he built.

JOAN DONOHUE (née MERCER), Matriarch

Born: April 17, 1948 **Age:** 74 on Jan 1, 2023 / 75 on Apr 20, 2023

Party: Democrat **Fame:** Living legend

- An Atlanta girl and a Spelman student when she met Victor. She broke off her engagement to Morehouse man **Thaddeus Smilley**, heir to the Smilley dynasty, and left for Hollywood.
- Respected, powerful, influential, ruthless, dangerous, and insanely wealthy. An award-winning actress, singer, director, and filmmaker.
- Carries quiet guilt over Thaddeus's death in 1974, and shows it to no one.

NATASHA BULLOCK (née DONOHUE), Mother & Manager

Born: June 2, 1971 **Age:** 51 on Jan 1, 2023 / 51 on Apr 20, 2023

Party: Democrat **Fame:** A-list legend; industry power player

- Only daughter of Victor and Joan. Award-winning, critically acclaimed actress and singer. **CEO of Donohue Entertainment (2006 to present)**, taking over at 35.
- Manages all three of her children's careers. Respected, powerful, influential, ruthless, dangerous, and insanely wealthy.
- Married Robert Bullock in 1991. Elxa was born in 1990, before the wedding (the family history rhymes).
- She knows exactly what Cornelius Smilley has done to her son and has been keeping a file of her own.

ROBERT BULLOCK, Father & Filmmaker

Born: February 10, 1969 **Age:** 53 on Jan 1, 2023 / 54 on Apr 20, 2023

Party: Independent (NPP) **Fame:** A-list director

- Respected, powerful, award-winning director. His breakout was ***Pulpit*** **(1997)**, made at 28 and produced by Victor: a searing drama about a beloved civil-rights preacher with a secret mistress and a church slush fund. Everyone in Atlanta knew who it was about. (Second wound of the feud.)
- Quiet and observant, his son's moral compass. Has directed Marc in two films.

ELXA BULLOCK, Eldest Child (future White House Chief of Staff)

Born: August 29, 1990 **Age:** 32 on Jan 1, 2023 / 32 on Apr 20, 2023

Party: Democrat **Fame:** A-list TV personality

- Eldest daughter of Natasha and Robert. Award-winning actress (an Emmy for a prestige drama in 2016) and the host of a hit talk and competition show.
- The family organizer, the one with the calendar, the list, and the plan. Runs her own production company like a war room. A natural Chief of Staff.
- Protective older sister. The only person who can make Marc stop joking.

Career challenge: Critics now see her as more "personality" than actress. She's fighting to be taken seriously in dramatic roles again.

MARC-ANTHONY BULLOCK, The Protagonist

Born: January 5, 1992 **Age:** 30 on Jan 1, 2023 / 31 on Apr 20, 2023

Party: Democrat (Republican values) **Fame:** Global icon (the most famous person on earth)

- Second-born child and oldest son of Natasha and Robert. Grandson of Victor and Joan. Born at Cedars-Sinai Medical Center, Los Angeles. Grew up in **Baldwin Hills, Los Angeles**, next door to Amond Baker. In 2023, lives with Esther and the twins at **Sunrise Hill**, the family estate in Bel Air.
- **Child star on both networks:** *Marc My Words* (Donohue Channel, 2002–2006) and *Kid Mayor* (Nickelodeon, 2006–2009), where he played a 13-year-old elected mayor of his town. The internet will dig *Kid Mayor* up within minutes of April 20, 2023.
- Critically acclaimed, award-winning actor, singer, screenwriter, director, and producer: Emmys, Grammys (for Broadway cast albums and movie-musical soundtracks), a Tony, and two Oscar nominations (see Cornelius's sabotage). Becomes the youngest President in history at 33.
- **Where the $990B+ comes from:** invested his child-star earnings from age 13. Bought **625,000 Bitcoin for about $50,000 in July 2010** at 18 (about $10B by Jan 1, 2023). Made early stakes in pre-IPO tech and AI companies. Built **Bullock Holdings**, a privately held conglomerate spanning media, tech, AI, real estate, and energy (valued around $800B). Holds about **12% of Donohue Entertainment** (about $180B). Because the holdings are private, Forbes and Bloomberg estimates disagree by hundreds of billions, which is a recurring media story. The "first trillionaire" countdown is a running headline.
- Unhinged, unfiltered, offensive comedy alongside a pure heart. A reported IQ of 250. Bends rules to help people (for example, quietly paying off a whole school district's lunch debt and medical bills in 2019, then fighting the district's red tape that tried to refuse it).
- Friends with Esther Smilley since childhood. Together in 2011, twins born May 10, 2012, married in 2013. Despite the feud, and partly because of it.

GRACE BULLOCK, Youngest Child (future White House Press Secretary)

Born: April 12, 1994 **Age:** 28 on Jan 1, 2023 / 29 on Apr 20, 2023

Party: Democrat **Fame:** A-list

- Award-winning actress and singer. Ride or die: she would hide a body for her brother. Quick, fearless, and dangerously funny on camera.
- Shreds trolls online in real time, which makes her a natural future Press Secretary and a tabloid magnet.

Career challenge: Forever labeled "Marc's little sister." Fighting to be seen for her own work.

5. Marc's Inner Circle

AMOND BAKER, Best Friend / Brother / Right-Hand Man (2024 running mate; future Vice President)

Born: February 10, 1992 **Age:** 30 on Jan 1, 2023 / 31 on Apr 20, 2023

Party: Democrat **Fame:** A-/B+ list

- Marc's next-door neighbor in Baldwin Hills since they were 4. They met fighting over a Power Wheels car. Co-starred as Marc's best friend on *Kid Mayor*.
- Actor and singer. Married **Harmony Divine** in 2015. Their daughter Lyric was born in 2014, and Marc is her godfather.
- Steady, loyal, the calm to Marc's chaos. The only person who tells Marc "no" and gets listened to.

Career challenge: Dry spell and sidekick typecasting. After a 2019 box-office hit, he hasn't landed a lead. Hollywood only casts him as "the best friend."

HARMONY BAKER (née DIVINE)

Born: June 19, 1992 **Age:** 30 on Jan 1, 2023 / 30 on Apr 20, 2023

Party: Democrat **Fame:** A- list (Broadway royalty)

- Harlem-born. Trained at the Ailey School from age 7. Made her Broadway debut at 14. Primarily a dancer who dabbled in acting (mostly Broadway) and is now a full-time actress.
- Award-winning actress and dancer, including a Tony. Born on Juneteenth, which the internet loves.

Career challenge: Typecasting: Hollywood sees "the dancer" and only offers musicals.

TYRESE AVERY, Global Pop Superstar

Born: July 24, 1991 **Age:** 31 on Jan 1, 2023 / 31 on Apr 20, 2023

Party: No Party Preference **Fame:** A-list global (top 5 most-streamed artists)

- Famous worldwide as a singer and pop star, and also an actor. Debut album in 2009 at 18. Stadium tours on six continents.
- Publicly apolitical to protect a global fanbase. Privately one of Marc's closest friends.
- **LOCKED: the new Kang the Conqueror, in total secrecy.** Secretly cast in Jan 2024 (codename "Project Chronopolis") after Marvel drops Jonathan Majors. Even the masked Kang at Comic-Con (Jul 27, 2024) gives nothing away. The world finds out when Kang removes his helmet on screen at the *Avengers: The Kang Dynasty* preview night (Thu May 1, 2025). He makes the role his own and becomes **synonymous with Kang** (see Bible 06).

Career challenge: Trouble translating to serious acting (as of 2023). Critics dismiss him as "a pop star playing pretend." Kang is the role that ends that.

ARIANNA CUMMINGS (future U.S. Attorney General)

Born: October 25, 1992 **Age:** 30 on Jan 1, 2023 / 30 on Apr 20, 2023

Party: Democrat **Fame:** B+ list

- Critically acclaimed, award-nominated actress: three Emmy nominations, no win yet.
- **Realism key: she is a real lawyer.** Stanford BA (2014) and Harvard Law JD (2017), earned while acting part-time. She passed the California Bar in 2018. That makes her eventual Attorney General nomination plausible, and her Senate confirmation hearing a war.
- Starred as a federal prosecutor on the network procedural *Justice Cole* (2017–2022).

Career challenge: Typecasting: Hollywood only offers her lawyer roles. Opponents will later sneer "TV-lawyer AG," not knowing she has a JD.

TYLER CHAPMAN

Born: January 4, 1992 **Age:** 30 on Jan 1, 2023 / 31 on Apr 20, 2023

Party: Republican **Fame:** B list

- Actor and musician, born in Houston, and the lead guitarist of a Black rock band that broke up in 2019. Born one day before Marc and never lets him forget it ("Respect your elders").
- One of Hollywood's few openly Republican Black actors. Marc's friend and, later, his bridge to the GOP.

Career challenge: Dry spell: no steady work since 2019, made worse by Hollywood quietly freezing him out over his politics.

TAYIA BOYD

Born: February 3, 1992 **Age:** 30 on Jan 1, 2023 / 31 on Apr 20, 2023

Party: No Party Preference **Fame:** B list (huge nostalgia fanbase)

- Actress from Detroit. Marc's co-star on *Marc My Words* and *Kid Mayor*. They have an excellent working relationship, and she knows where every childhood skeleton is buried.
- Funny, grounded, and loyal.

Career challenge: Trouble translating to mature work: fans and casting directors still see her as "Deedee" from *Marc My Words*.

6. The Next Generation

EMMA BULLOCK, Older Twin (by 25 minutes)

Born: May 10, 2012 **Age:** 10 on Jan 1, 2023 / 10 on Apr 20, 2023

Party: n/a **Fame:** Famous by birth

- Daughter of Marc-Anthony and Esther. A 1000% daddy's girl, spoiled endlessly, but knows the true meaning of hard work. Respectful and responsible.
- She is Marc's twin: nearly all her talent and personality come from him. Gen Z, but raised as a Millennial.

VICTORIA BULLOCK, Younger Twin

Born: May 10, 2012 **Age:** 10 on Jan 1, 2023 / 10 on Apr 20, 2023

Party: n/a **Fame:** Famous by birth

- A 1000% daddy's girl, spoiled endlessly, but she works hard. Respectful and responsible, and a wild child (contained). Nearly all her talent and personality come from Marc. Gen Z, raised as a Millennial.
- Born before her parents' 2013 wedding, a fact Cornelius Smilley has never forgiven.

LYRIC BAKER, Goddaughter

Born: April 20, 2014 **Age:** 8 on Jan 1, 2023 / 9 on Apr 20, 2023

Party: n/a **Fame:** Famous by birth

- Daughter of Amond and Harmony. Marc is her godfather. A sweetheart and an angel. Gen Alpha, raised as a Millennial.
- **Continuity gold:** she turns **9 on Thursday, April 20, 2023**, the day of Marc's spur-of-the-moment announcement. **Locked:** Marc announces *at her 9th birthday party* at Sunrise Hill. Lyric asks, "Uncle Marc, why can't YOU be President? You fix everything." He answers "...You know what? Bet," live on Instagram to 640 million followers at **4:20 PM PDT**. He swears the timing was an accident. Nobody believes him.

7. The Smilley Family: A Political Dynasty

Base: Atlanta, Georgia, and Washington, D.C. **Estimated family fortune:** about $400 million (Atlanta real estate, Cornelius's lobbying empire, and church-era holdings). **Motto (stitched in Odessa's parlor):** *"We were here before the cameras, and we'll be here after."*

Dynasty Timeline

Date	Event
Feb 1, 1925	Josiah Smilley is born in Albany, Georgia, the son of a sharecropper.
1952	Josiah becomes pastor of Greater Mount Calvary Baptist Church in Atlanta (fictional), which becomes the political pulpit of the South.
1963–1965	Josiah marches on Washington and at Selma. The movement makes him a national figure.
1966	Josiah is elected to the Georgia legislature, among the first Black lawmakers there since Reconstruction.
1969	Eldest son **Thaddeus**, a Morehouse man and the heir, is engaged to Spelman student **Joan Mercer**. Victor Donohue arrives in Atlanta to film. Joan leaves Thaddeus for Victor.
1970	Joan marries Victor Donohue. Thaddeus learns it from the newspaper.
Aug 17, 1974	Thaddeus, 27, dies in a single-car crash on I-75. Cornelius, 16, idolized him. The family blames the Donohues.
1976	Josiah founds the **Georgia Voters League**, the "Smilley Machine," a get-out-the-vote operation that can deliver Black church voters across the South. The same year, Victor Donohue becomes CEO of Donohue Entertainment.
1992	Cornelius, 34, is elected to the U.S. House from a metro Atlanta district (an alternate-timeline seat) and sworn in in January 1993.
Oct 1997	***Pulpit*** is released, directed by Robert Bullock and produced by Victor. Its preacher is unmistakably Josiah. Cornelius's planned 1998 Senate run collapses.
1998–2000	Cornelius sues Donohue Entertainment for defamation and loses. The court accepts the defense that it was fiction, and quiet evidence emerges that the story was largely true. The family's deepest shame.
2002	Esther, 10, is cast in *Esther Ever After* (Donohue Channel, 2002–2006). Lorraine's long game: Shirley Temple became Ambassador Shirley Temple Black. Fame first, then power.
2003	Esther meets Marc at a Donohue Channel event. Instant best friends. Cornelius forbids it, and they stay friends in secret.
Jan 15, 2009	Josiah dies at 83 (on Martin Luther King Jr.'s birthday). Cornelius leaves Congress the same month to become a lobbyist and Democratic kingmaker.
2011–2013	Marc and Esther fall in love (she is 18, he is 19). The twins are born May 10, 2012. They marry on **Saturday, June 15, 2013**, at the Sunrise Tower in Donohue Dreamland, Anaheim, with 1,200 guests. Cornelius refuses to attend, and the photo of his empty chair goes viral. Odessa attends anyway.
Jan 2017	Cornelius makes a bid for DNC Chair. A viral roast clip from Marc derails it, and he withdraws before the Feb 25, 2017 vote.
2023	The plan: Esther for Congress in 2024, the Senate in 2026, the White House in 2032 (she turns 35 on Sep 20, 2027). Then April 20 happens.

The Smilleys

REV. DR. JOSIAH SMILLEY (Feb 1, 1925 – Jan 15, 2009), Founder (deceased)

Party: Democrat **Fame:** Civil-rights icon

- A preacher, legislator, and movement hero, and a secret adulterer who ran a church slush fund. *Pulpit* told the truth, which is why it burned so badly.
- His portrait hangs over every Smilley family dinner. His legacy is the family religion.

ODESSA SMILLEY (née GRANT), Matriarch

Born: October 3, 1928 **Age:** 94 on Jan 1, 2023 / 94 on Apr 20, 2023

Party: Democrat **Fame:** Atlanta royalty

- Josiah's widow. Sharp as a razor at 94. Knew about the mistress all along and stayed for the movement and the children.
- The only Smilley who openly loves Marc. She went to the wedding over Cornelius's objection, and the twins call her "Big Mama." The bridge between the families. Her eventual death will be a major story beat.

THADDEUS SMILLEY (Mar 12, 1947 – Aug 17, 1974), The Lost Heir

Party: Democrat **Fame:** Atlanta's golden son

- The heir who should have been Senator and maybe more. Joan Mercer's ex-fiance. His death made Cornelius the heir and turned grief into a 50-year vendetta.

CORNELIUS AUGUSTUS SMILLEY, Esther's Father (Primary Antagonist)

Born: August 8, 1958 **Age:** 64 on Jan 1, 2023 / 64 on Apr 20, 2023

Party: Democrat **Fame:** Washington power broker

- Morehouse (1980), Georgetown Law (JD, 1983). U.S. Congressman (1993–2009). Now the founder of **Smilley Strategies** on K Street, controls a super PAC, sits on corporate boards (including a major studio), and runs the Georgia Voters League.
- Brilliant, patient, connected, charming in public, and cold in private. **Not nerfed:** he is one of the most effective political operators in America.
- Considers Esther his golden ticket to the White House and the fulfillment of Josiah's and Thaddeus's destiny.

LORRAINE SMILLEY (née BEAUMONT), Esther's Mother

Born: December 12, 1961 **Age:** 61 on Jan 1, 2023 / 61 on Apr 20, 2023

Party: Democrat **Fame:** Washington society

- Former Miss Black America contestant, Howard University graduate, and the most feared hostess in Washington. The family's real strategist, and the architect of Esther's child-star career.
- **The twist:** she wants Esther in the White House as badly as Cornelius does, but she's a pragmatist. When Marc announces, she sees what Cornelius refuses to see: Marc might be the fastest route to power. That splits the parents and gives the dynasty a civil war.

DR. BEATRICE "BEA" SMILLEY-OWENS, Aunt & Godmother

Born: May 5, 1955 **Age:** 67 on Jan 1, 2023 / 67 on Apr 20, 2023

Party: Democrat **Fame:** Respected in legal circles

- Cornelius's older sister. A civil-rights attorney who litigated voting-rights cases across the South. Esther's godmother.
- The family's conscience and a quiet ally to Marc and Esther. Knows things about Cornelius that could end him.

CORNELIUS "NEIL" SMILLEY JR., Eldest Child

Born: March 22, 1984 **Age:** 38 on Jan 1, 2023 / 39 on Apr 20, 2023

Party: Democrat **Fame:** Regional (Georgia politics)

- Georgia State Senator from metro Atlanta. Dutiful, competent, and lacking charisma.
- Was supposed to be the heir until his father decided Esther's star power was the better bet. Resentful of being passed over, and quietly vulnerable to being turned by either side.

SIMONE SMILLEY, Middle Child (the Black Sheep)

Born: July 7, 1987 **Age:** 35 on Jan 1, 2023 / 35 on Apr 20, 2023

Party: Republican **Fame:** National TV political commentator

- Republican strategist and cable news contributor. Became a conservative in college, partly out of conviction and partly out of rebellion.
- Cornelius treats her like a traitor. She is brilliant, and she may end up working *against* Marc for the GOP or, in a twist, working *with* him on his bipartisan agenda.

ESTHER BULLOCK (née SMILLEY), Heiress & Marc's Soulmate

Born: September 20, 1992 **Age:** 30 on Jan 1, 2023 / 30 on Apr 20, 2023

Party: Democrat **Fame:** A-list ("America's sweetheart")

- Youngest of three. Child actress and heiress to the Smilley dynasty. Critically acclaimed, award-winning actress and singer (Emmys, a Tony, and a Grammy for Best Musical Theater Album). Described as a **modern-day Shirley Temple**, known for her natural beauty, distinctive features, and effortless elegance.
- Her father and mother both want her to run for office, specifically President, and see her as their golden ticket.
- Marc's friend since 2003 and his wife since June 15, 2013. She chose love over the dynasty and has been fighting to keep both ever since.

Career challenge: Trouble translating to mature work: the "Shirley Temple" image follows her everywhere. Her darkest, most adult role (2021) won raves from critics, but audiences rejected it.

8. Why the Smilleys Hate the Donohues: The Three Wounds

Two Black American dynasties, **one built on politics, one built on Hollywood**, each convinced it is the true keeper of Black power in America. The Smilleys see the Donohues as flashy and amoral, people who sell images. The Donohues see the Smilleys as hypocrites who sell sermons. Fifty years of blood are underneath that.

- **Wound 1, The Bride (1969–1974).** Joan Mercer left Thaddeus Smilley, the dynasty's heir, for Victor Donohue and Hollywood. Five years later Thaddeus was dead. To the Smilleys, the Donohues took their future and their son.
- **Wound 2, The Film (1997).** *Pulpit*, directed by Robert Bullock and produced by Victor, exposed Josiah Smilley's affair and slush fund to the world. It killed Cornelius's Senate run, and the defamation lawsuit failed because the story was essentially true. Being exposed by the people who "stole" Thaddeus is the humiliation the Smilleys can never forgive.
- **Wound 3, The Daughter (2011–present).** Esther, the dynasty's golden ticket, fell in love with Victor's grandson and Robert Bullock's son, had his children, and took his name. History repeated itself: once again a Donohue walked off with the Smilley future.
- **The rivalry today:** rival galas, rival donors, competing endorsements, and holidays shared through gritted teeth "for the children." Two dynasties bound together by the twins, and neither will let go.

9. Why Cornelius Smilley 1000% Hates Marc-Anthony

- **He took Esther.** Cornelius spent 20 years building his daughter into a future President. Marc, a Donohue grandson, got her pregnant at 19, married her, and made her a Bullock.
- **He is the son of the man who made *Pulpit*.** Every time Cornelius looks at Marc, he sees Robert Bullock, the director who destroyed his father's name.
- **He is the ghost of Thaddeus, reversed.** A Donohue took Thaddeus's bride and future. A Donohue took Esther. Cornelius believes the Donohues are a curse on his bloodline.
- **The roast (January 2017).** While Cornelius was running for DNC Chair, Marc did a devastating, unfiltered impression of him ("Brother Cornelius," complete with the comb-over and the collection plate) on a comedy special. It went mega-viral and became a meme, and Cornelius withdrew. To Cornelius, Marc publicly ended his last shot at national power, laughing.
- **The twins.** His granddaughters are 1000% daddy's girls, raised as Bullocks and not Smilleys. They adore Marc. They are polite to their grandfather.
- **Envy.** Marc effortlessly has everything Cornelius has clawed for his whole life: love, fame, money, the public's adoration. Worst of all, he's genuinely kind. Marc keeps trying to win his approval, and that drives Cornelius further over the edge.
- **Fear.** Cornelius is the one man who saw it coming: with that IQ, that charisma, and that money, Marc could take the White House that was supposed to be Esther's. On April 20, 2023, his nightmare comes true.

Cornelius's War on Marc's Acting Career (2012–2022)

When	What he did	Result
2011–2012	Tried to bury the pregnancy. Planted the rumor that Marc had abandoned Esther.	Failed. Marc publicly showed up for every doctor's appointment.
2014	Used his Georgetown Law classmate, studio chief Gideon Kessler, to kill Marc's first major studio franchise deal.	Marc made it independently through Donohue and Bullock Holdings. It was a hit.
2017–2018	After the roast, fed Marc's most offensive old stand-up clips to advocacy groups to spark boycotts.	A week-long firestorm. Marc apologized with humor and grace, and fans rallied.

When	What he did	Result
2020 & 2022	Ran Oscar whisper campaigns: "difficult on set," "nepo baby," "his comedy is hateful."	**His one real win:** Marc was nominated both times and didn't win. The missing "O" in his EGOT is Cornelius's trophy.
2021	Secretly financed a tell-all memoir by former child co-star Jaxon Wilde.	A bestseller for a week. Debunked by Tayia Boyd on live TV.
Ongoing	Has paid investigators for years to compile **"The Bullock File,"** a 400-page opposition dossier.	Sitting in a safe in Atlanta, waiting for the 2024 campaign.

Not nerfed: every attack is smart, deniable, and well-funded. Marc only suspects a fraction of it. Natasha suspects much more and has a file of her own.

10. Additional Original Characters

The real world is diverse, so this supporting cast is too.

GIDEON KESSLER, Studio Chief (white)

Born: March 9, 1958 **Age:** 64 on Jan 1, 2023 / 65 on Apr 20, 2023

Party: Democrat (mega-donor) **Fame:** Industry titan

- Chairman and CEO of Meridian Pictures (fictional). Cornelius's Georgetown Law classmate (class of 1983). The most powerful man in Hollywood who isn't a Donohue.
- Cornelius's inside man. Charming, shrewd, and always calculating who's winning.

JAXON WILDE, Former Child Co-Star (white)

Born: June 1, 1991 **Age:** 31 on Jan 1, 2023 / 31 on Apr 20, 2023

Party: Republican **Fame:** C list (fading)

- Played Marc's rival on *Marc My Words*. Has been stuck in a dry spell since his early 20s, and his bitterness has curdled into envy.
- Wrote the 2021 tell-all. In 2023 he launches a right-wing podcast built around attacking Marc, which becomes a real campaign headache.

NADIA OKAFOR, Investigative Reporter (Nigerian-American)

Born: November 2, 1985 **Age:** 37 on Jan 1, 2023 / 37 on Apr 20, 2023

Party: Unaffiliated **Fame:** Respected national journalist

- Investigative reporter on a major Washington newspaper's politics desk. A Pulitzer finalist. Fair, relentless, and impossible to intimidate.
- The journalist most likely to get her hands on "The Bullock File," and to dig into Cornelius too.

DANTE REYES, Head of Marc's Private Security (Puerto Rican)

Born: February 14, 1981 **Age:** 41 on Jan 1, 2023 / 42 on Apr 20, 2023

Party: Registered Independent **Fame:** Unknown to the public

- Former U.S. Secret Service agent on a presidential protective detail. Has run Marc's private security since 2015. Calm and lethal, and Emma and Victoria's favorite adult who isn't family.
- Becomes the bridge to the Secret Service once Marc becomes a candidate.

DANIELLE "DANI" SHAW, President & COO of Donohue Entertainment

Born: September 9, 1977 **Age:** 45 on Jan 1, 2023 / 45 on Apr 20, 2023

Party: Democrat **Fame:** Industry insider

- Natasha's right hand and fixer. A former crisis-communications prodigy from Chicago. Knows where every Donohue body is buried, and has buried a few herself.
- Fiercely loyal to Natasha. Her loyalty to Marc, once politics enters, is an open question.

WES THORNTON, Republican Strategist (white)

Born: April 2, 1979 **Age:** 43 on Jan 1, 2023 / 44 on Apr 20, 2023

Party: Republican **Fame:** Political insider

- An Ohio-born GOP strategist who has worked Senate and presidential campaigns. Simone Smilley's mentor.
- A top-tier opposition operative, and the most dangerous man on the other side of the aisle once Marc enters the race.

11. Fame & Career Status (as of January 1, 2023)

Character	Fame tier	Instagram (approx.)	Career challenge
Marc-Anthony Bullock	Global icon (#1)	~640M (most-followed person on Earth)	No Oscar yet (Cornelius's sabotage). Old comedy clips.
Tyrese Avery	Global A-list	~290M	Not taken seriously as an actor (until Kang, 2024–25)
Esther Bullock	A-list	~310M	Trouble translating to mature work (the Shirley Temple image)
Grace Bullock	A-list	~120M	"Marc's little sister" label
Elxa Bullock	A-list TV	~95M	Seen as a personality, not an actress
Harmony Baker	A- (Broadway royalty)	~40M	Typecast as "the dancer"
Amond Baker	A-/B+	~55M	Dry spell, sidekick typecasting
Arianna Cummings	B+	~22M	Typecast in lawyer roles. Award-nominated, never a winner.
Tayia Boyd	B (nostalgia)	~30M	Trouble translating to mature work
Tyler Chapman	B	~8M	Dry spell, frozen out over his politics
Jaxon Wilde	C (fading)	~2M	Long dry spell, bitterness

12. Continuity Notes

- Elxa (1990) was born before Natasha and Robert married (1991). The twins (2012) were born before Marc and Esther married (2013). Lyric (2014) was born before Amond and Harmony married (2015). The press and the Smilleys will notice the pattern.
- Marc is the second-born child and the oldest son. Esther is the youngest of three.
- Tyler is exactly one day older than Marc (Jan 4 vs. Jan 5, 1992).
- Lyric's 9th birthday is the day of the announcement (Apr 20, 2023). The twins turn 11 on May 10, 2023.
- Wedding: Saturday, June 15, 2013, at the Sunrise Tower, Donohue Dreamland, Anaheim. Esther was 20, Marc 21, and the twins were 1 year and 1 month old. Cornelius's empty chair went viral, and Odessa sat in the front row.
- Kim Ju Ae's canon birthday: Wednesday, January 30, 2013 (see Bible 02).
- Age requirement: resolved by the 28th Amendment (see the top of this document). Marc is sworn in Jan 20, 2025, at 33.